

TOP PREDATOR

The deadliest sharks are powerful hunters that prey on big fish, seals, and other large animals. They are built for speed, especially the great white shark—the biggest and most efficient hunter of them all. Armed with large jaws and a combination of highly tuned senses for detecting and targeting its prey, the great white is in a class of its own.

▲ SUPER SENSES

Like all predatory sharks, the great white has excellent vision, while its super-sensitive nostrils can pick up the slightest trace of blood in the water up to 3 miles (5 km) away. Most amazingly, the pores on its snout contain sensors that detect the tiny electrical pulses generated by its prey's nervous system.

▲ JAWS AND TEETH

The great white has teeth like saw-edged razors for slicing up its prey. As with all sharks, old teeth are always being replaced by new ones that form inside its jaws, pointing inward. These gradually turn upright as the older teeth move to the outside of the jaws and fall out.

Long pectoral fins act like wings as the shark moves forward, stopping it from sinking

Pale underside makes the shark hard to see from below, enabling it to sneak up on prey

SPRINGY SKELETONS

The skeleton of a shark is not made of bone, but springy cartilage—the same material that supports your ears. The skeleton doesn't need to be very strong because the shark's weight is supported by the water. Its main job is to anchor the shark's powerful body muscles.

